A PRIVATE OFFERING · 30 SEPTEMBER 2026

For Camilla Benbow *and* David Lubinski

Dear Camilla and David,

Thank you for a lifetime of research that takes lives like mine seriously, and for making time for me this summer. You asked me to send media that represents my past, present and future. This is my humble attempt: a record built from documents I can point to, that you can search, sort, question and take apart. Every entry says where it came from and how sure I am.

Nothing here asks anything of you.

Gordon Bellamy
COHORT 3, STUDY OF MATHEMATICALLY PRECOCIOUS YOUTH

01 · WHAT THIS IS

Read this first

- A dated, sourced record of my life in three parts: the record (timeline, relief view, table, downloads), the media room (past, present, future), a note to each of you, and a few words of my own.
- Built from public documents and from my own files. Each event is marked

02 · WHAT THIS IS NOT

And what it is not

- Not SMPY data. It holds no scores and makes no claim about the cohort, about talent in general, or about what one life proves. One life is one life.
- Not a request. There is no reply expected, no funding, no meeting, and no tracking. This page makes no network requests except to links you choose to open.

`DOCUMENT`, `RECORD IN MY FILES`, or `MY OWN ACCOUNT`.

- Yours to use however helps your work, in whole or in part.
- Yours to cite. Quote it or cite any part of it however serves your work, and please ask me anything about any entry. I welcome every question.
- Yours to decline. Delete it at any time, for any reason, without a word.

TEN MINUTES

Start here

If you have only a few minutes, these eight entries carry the arc, from the talent search that found me to the work I do now. Each opens its source in the record below.

1 `1976 to 1983 (approx.)` **Identified as a prodigy in first grade; Ms. Shainis and one magical year**
Where it began: a first-grade teacher and a program built for children like us.

2 `1980 to 1983` **Identified into SMPY Cohort 3**
The talent search that identified me into your Cohort 3.

3 `November 1984` **Presented to the U.S. Department of Education at fourteen**
At fourteen, telling the U.S. Department of Education what the program meant.

4 `1987` **Research Science Institute (RSI), summer 1987**
A summer of real research at seventeen.

5 `June 1993` **A cold call from my Harvard dorm room to Electronic Arts, then Rookie of the Year**
The cold call that started a career in games.

6 `2006` **Co-founded Gay Gaming Professionals (GGP)**
Building something for people I had once needed.

7 `2015` **Began teaching at USC School of Cinematic Arts**
Teaching the next generation at USC.

8 `March 2026` **Keynote at a Congressional Reception on Capitol Hill**
Returning to Capitol Hill, forty-two years after the first time.

For both of you

You have led the Study of Mathematically Precocious Youth together at Vanderbilt since 1998, carrying forward what Julian Stanley began in 1971. These are the pieces of your work I have read again while preparing this:

- Co-directors of the Study of Mathematically Precocious Youth, at Vanderbilt since 1998
- The 2026 Dunnette Prize from SIOP, shared, for programmatic, significant and lasting contributions to the understanding of the role of individual differences
- Two Gifted Child Quarterly Papers of the Year, the most recent for In their own voice(s), on what participants say in their own words
- Composing Meaningful Lives: Exceptional Women and Men at Age 50, Gifted Child Quarterly, 2023
- Nature, 2016: the profile that describes you at work together

WHAT YOUR WORK GAVE ME, IN MY OWN WORDS

From my email to David, copied to Camilla, on 17 June 2026.

> *Your warmth then, clearing your afternoon to help a Cohort 3 kid prepare for a talk, meant a great deal to me. I still point people to the Nature piece and the documentary you sent.*

> *Reading my own age-50 follow up reflected back in that work was moving. It is a generous thing, to spend a career taking these lives seriously.*

> *Ability matters, but opportunity and individuality are what turn it into a life.*

Thank you both, for the science and for the kindness.

NOTE TWO 02

For Camilla

You have been Dean of Peabody College since 1998, and, alongside David, a steward of a study that has followed children for more than five decades. In your 2024 interview

on your reappointment you spoke of a talent development lens, and of AI, social entrepreneurship and taking Peabody to the world (The Vanderbilt Hustler).

I work in that neighborhood. I teach, I lead ethics for a film and games school, and I help run a nonprofit scholars program that looks for ability where it is easy to overlook and tries to attach opportunity to it. I offer that as context, not as a pitch.

NOTE THREE 03

For David

Three ideas from your work sit closest to what this record shows: that ability is a pattern and not a single number, that interests and preferences shape where ability goes, and that how people allocate their time is part of how they compose a meaningful life. I have not tried to apply them to myself. The record supplies dated outcomes and leaves the interpretation, and the scores, to you.

Games are a spatial, technical and social craft, and I have not found SMPY writing about them. If one life in that field is ever useful to you, this is one, and you are welcome to use it or ignore it.

One small coincidence. Nature notes that you wrestled. In February 1992 I covered Harvard's wrestling team for The Crimson ("Grapplers Drop Two More Contests"). The team lost. I hope the prose held up better.

NOTE FOUR 04

In my own words

I have carried your study with me for most of my life. I still point people to the Nature piece and the documentary you sent, and when I read your paper on age 50 I recognized my own cohort in it. It is a rare thing to be taken seriously by a body of science.

What I did with that: I built a career where games and education meet. I led the IGDA, I teach at USC, I lead ethics for a film and games school, and I co-founded a nonprofit that pays its scholars directly and looks for ability where it is easy to overlook.

If a participant's view is ever useful, here is mine. Your brief says that exceptional talent exists in unexpected places, and I have seen it. David has said these children often need earlier access to what is already available. I would only add that talent is easier to see when the people looking have been taught to see it, so I try to teach the people who do the looking.

Family, for me, is chosen and durable: Joe, my son Brennan, and friends I have known for forty years. They taught me that a trajectory is a shared thing, and that no one gets there alone.

Now I am trying to make AI useful for the same reason, and to keep people in the picture. Thank you for taking these lives seriously. I am glad to be one of them.

Gordon Bellamy

The record

Two views of the same 97 events, and a table with everything in it. Select a marker or a row to see its source and how sure I am. The top strip of the timeline places SMPY's follow-up ages on my own calendar, only to help you line events up with your waves. Future items are intentions, so they live in the media room and are not plotted.

Every event, with its source and how sure I am. Ages are approximate.

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
1970	0	Education	context	**Born; childhood in Reston, Virginia** I grew up in Reston, Virginia.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own records (available on request)
1976 to 1983 (approx.)	5 to 13	Education	opportunity	**Identified as a prodigy in first grade; Ms. Shainis and one magical year** My alma mater's spotlight says I was identified as a prodigy in first grade. I have written publicly that one teacher, Ms. Lara Shainis, and her multi-school program at Kent Gardens, Sunrise Valley and Hughes were the most inspired idea and execution of my education. She is where my story really begins. Exact grades and years are approximate.	DOCUMENT	St. Paul's School alumni spotlight, Class of 1988

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
1980 to 1983	9 to 13	SMPY	opportunity	**Identified into SMPY Cohort 3** Cohort 3 was identified through the national talent search, 1980 to 1983 (SMPY's own definition). I do not state my scores or the year; you hold those.	RECORD IN MY FILES	Lubinski and Benbow 2006, SMPY after 35 years, Table 1; our 2016 to 2026 correspondence
1980 to 1986 (approx.)	9 to 16	Education	opportunity	**Summers with Johns Hopkins CTY and Duke TIP** The two university talent searches that sit beside SMPY. A guidance counselor told my seventh grade English class about the Duke test; I qualified on a January morning and took a mathematics course at Duke that summer, on an Atlantic Richfield merit scholarship. I attended both programs; I do not have every year or site and will not guess.	DOCUMENT	St. Paul's School alumni spotlight, Class of 1988
1984	13 to 14	Education	outcome	**MATHCOUNTS national championship** Named in my alma mater's alumni spotlight as part of the 1984 MATHCOUNTS national championship. The spotlight also mentions Johns Hopkins CTY and Duke TIP.	DOCUMENT	St. Paul's School alumni spotlight, Class of 1988
1984	13 to 14	Education	outcome	**First in the nation in the Continental Math League; first in Virginia Math Counts oral presentation** From my own 1984 remarks: number one in the nation in the Continental Math League (founded in 1980, so only four years old then), first place in Virginia's Math Counts oral presentation on transformational geometry, and a member of the four-member Virginia team that placed first in the nation. The MATHCOUNTS win was the competition's inaugural national championship.	RECORD IN MY FILES	Transcript of my remarks, 14 November 1984

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
November 1984	14	Education	turning point	**Presented to the U.S. Department of Education at fourteen** On 14 November 1984, five days after my fourteenth birthday, I addressed the Education Forum at the United States Department of Education in Washington, alongside two other students and Dr. Robert N. Sawyer, Director of the Duke University Talent Identification Program. My remarks were on what the program meant to me: the awards I had earned, my sense of responsibility to my school community, and gratitude to my teachers and family. I have the full transcript. In 2019 I wrote that it is interesting to hear how I described trajectory then and how I talk about it now.	RECORD IN MY FILES	Transcript of my remarks, posted by me on Facebook, 17 April 2019
1985 to 1986	14 to 15	Education	opportunity	**Phillips Exeter Academy, 1985 to 1986** I attended Phillips Exeter Academy for the 1985 to 1986 school year, before finishing at St. Paul's School.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My LinkedIn education record
1986	15 to 16	Education	opportunity	**Virginia Governor's School, NASA Langley internship** A state gifted program that placed a teenager in a research setting, a year before RSI. My Governor's School experience in 1986 was an internship at NASA Langley Research Center.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own public posts (Facebook, 2017 to 2019)
1987	16 to 17	Education	opportunity	**Research Science Institute (RSI), summer 1987** RSI at MIT, run by the Center for Excellence in Education. Years later CEE and I revived the connection through a Rickover-themed game jam.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own account; the CEE relationship is in my mailbox

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
1988	17 to 18	Education	context	**St. Paul's School, Class of 1988** Graduated from St. Paul's School.	DOCUMENT	St. Paul's School alumni spotlight
1990 to 1994 (approx.)	19 to 24	Education	outcome	**John Harvard Scholar and AT&T Bell Labs Engineering Scholar** Named a John Harvard Scholar and an AT&T Bell Labs Engineering Scholar at Harvard. I also took part in the Hasty Pudding, Speech and Parliamentary Debate.	DOCUMENT	Wikipedia (secondary), confirmed by me
1990 to 1995	19 to 24	Education	context	**Harvard College, engineering** BA in Engineering from Harvard College. I started in September 1990. In 1993 a summer internship at Electronic Arts became a permanent job, and I returned to Harvard for the fall semester, September 1994 to January 1995, to finish. I graduated and went back to my full time job at EA.	DOCUMENT	USC School of Cinematic Arts faculty directory
1992	21 to 22	Work and industry	context	**Writer for The Harvard Crimson** Ten pieces in February to April 1992, mostly sports. One covered Harvard's wrestling team, "Grapplers Drop Two More Contests" (18 February 1992).	DOCUMENT	The Harvard Crimson, writer page
1993	22 to 23	Work and industry	turning point	**Joined Electronic Arts** A summer internship became a permanent job. My earliest credits, in 1993, are product testing on Madden NFL '94, testing on FIFA International Soccer, and a special thanks on Haunting Starring Polterguy.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own account; MobyGames credits

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
June 1993	22	Work and industry	turning point	**A cold call from my Harvard dorm room to Electronic Arts, then Rookie of the Year** I picked up a phone in my Harvard dorm room and cold called EA, and credit Jim Simmons, Eric Newhouse, Randy Delucchi, Bing Gordon and Richard Hilleman for what followed. I was named EA Corporate Rookie of the Year. Madden NFL '95 advanced technology to portray Black athletes in the game.	DOCUMENT	St. Paul's School alumni spotlight, Class of 1988
1994	23 to 24	Work and industry	outcome	**Assistant producer and designer, Madden NFL 95** Assistant producer on Madden NFL 95 for Genesis and SNES, with design credit on the SNES version and design adaptation on the Genesis version, assistant producer on IMG International Tour Tennis, and player ratings on John Madden Football (3DO) and Bill Walsh College Football 95, all 1994.	DOCUMENT	MobyGames and IMDb (my credits)
1995	24 to 25	Work and industry	outcome	**Associate producer and designer, Madden NFL 96** Associate producer on Madden NFL 96 for Genesis and SNES, with game design on the SNES version and design adaptation on the Genesis version, 1995.	DOCUMENT	MobyGames and IMDb (my credits)
January 1995	24	Work and industry	decision	**Graduated from Harvard and returned to full time work at Electronic Arts** After finishing my last semester (September 1994 to January 1995), I graduated and went back to my full time job at EA in January 1995. Later roles included Z-Axis, THQ and consulting for MTV and Spike TV (secondary sources).	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own account; trade-press profiles

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
1998	27 to 28	Work and industry	outcome	**Design credits on Alexi Lalas International Soccer and Fox Sports College Hoops '99** Design credits on Alexi Lalas International Soccer for PlayStation and Windows, and game design on Fox Sports College Hoops '99 for Nintendo 64, all 1998.	DOCUMENT	MobyGames and IMDb (my credits)
2001 to 2015	30 to 45	Media and honors	outcome	**Nine game-show appearances, in my own tape log** Logged in my own public tape log, including the full 2002 Russian Roulette episode on the Internet Archive.	RECORD IN MY FILES	The Tape Log
2001 to 2002	30 to 32	Work and industry	opportunity	**Director of Business Development, THQ** Business development at THQ, 2001 to 2002, before moving to the Academy of Interactive Arts and Sciences.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My LinkedIn profile
November 2003	33	Work and industry	opportunity	**Executive Director, Academy of Interactive Arts and Sciences** Named Executive Director of the Academy, which runs the D.I.C.E. Summit and awards, and led the 2004 D.I.C.E. Summit. My LinkedIn dates the Academy work from December 2002, which included an earlier business development role.	DOCUMENT	GameSpot, Spot On: The 2004 D.I.C.E. Summit
2004 to 2005	33 to 35	Work and industry	opportunity	**Creative consultant, Spike TV Video Game Awards; game consultant, Game Head** Creative consultant on the Spike TV Video Game Awards in 2004 and 2005, and game consultant on the television series Game Head in 2005.	DOCUMENT	IMDb (my profile)

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
2004 to 2007	33 to 37	Work and industry	opportunity	**Executive consultant to MTV Networks** Executive consultant to MTV Networks, April 2004 to February 2007, including work with Spike TV on games.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My LinkedIn profile
2006	35 to 36	Community and nonprofit	decision	**Co-founded Gay Gaming Professionals (GGP)** GGP is a nonprofit that opens doors to games careers, with a particular lens on LGBTQ+ professionals and students and a commitment to underestimated talent everywhere. Its scholars programs are its clearest outcome measure.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	Gay Gaming Professionals
2007	36 to 37	Media and honors	outcome	**Associate producer, Cooking with Kay** Associate producer credit on the short Cooking with Kay, 2007.	DOCUMENT	IMDb (my profile)
2007 to 2009	36 to 39	Work and industry	opportunity	**Double Fusion, then Image Metrics** Director of Business Development at in-game advertising company Double Fusion (2007 to 2008), then Senior Sales Executive at facial-animation company Image Metrics (2008 to 2009).	RECORD IN MY FILES	My LinkedIn profile
2010 to 2012	39 to 41	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**Executive Director, International Game Developers Association** Led the IGDA from August 2010 to July 2012, then joined Tencent.	DOCUMENT	GamesBeat, IGDA chief joins Tencent (July 2012)
September 2011	40	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Honorary chair and moderator, Changing the Game** Honorary chair and moderator of Changing the Game at Becker College, convened by the Joan Ganz Cooney Center, 14 September 2011.	DOCUMENT	Joan Ganz Cooney Center

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
2012 to 2013	41 to 43	Work and industry	opportunity	**Tencent, Director of Business Development and Industry Relations** Business development and industry relations for Tencent Games, 2012 to 2013.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My LinkedIn profile
2012	41 to 42	Media and honors	outcome	**On-camera interview, Microsoft Imagine Cup** An on-camera interview for the Microsoft Imagine Cup student technology competition, 2012.	DOCUMENT	YouTube
2013 to 2021	42 to 51	Media and honors	outcome	**Special thanks on independent games and films, 2013 to 2021** Credited with special thanks on Skullgirls (2013) and Skullgirls: 2nd Encore (2015), Gaming in Color (2014), 2064: Read Only Memories (2015), Fragments of Him (2016), Indivisible (2019), Jupiter & Mars (2019) and Boyfriend Dungeon (2021), among others.	DOCUMENT	MobyGames and IMDb (my credits)
2013 to 2015	42 to 45	Work and industry	opportunity	**Senior advisor, iDreamsky Technology** Senior advisor to the mobile games publisher iDreamsky Technology, 2013 to 2015.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
July 2014	43	SMPY	context	**Panelist, GiftedTogether conversation on gifted people** Sat on a panel about gifted people with GiftedTogether, July 2014. The organization thanked me for the panel afterward.	RECORD IN MY FILES	GiftedTogether post, 11 July 2014, as I saved it
December 2014	44	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**Advisory board member, IEP** Joined the advisory board of IEP, December 2014.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
2015	44 to 45	Teaching and ethics	turning point	**Began teaching at USC School of Cinematic Arts** Teaching in the Interactive Media and Games Division since about 2015.	DOCUMENT	USC SCA faculty directory; Daily Trojan profile

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
2015 to 2021	44 to 51	Work and industry	opportunity	**Advisor, Ninja Metrics** Advisor to the game analytics company Ninja Metrics, 2015 to January 2021.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
2016	45 to 46	Work and industry	opportunity	**Co-founder, Hangry Studios** Co-founded Hangry Studios, a quality assurance consultancy for PC, mobile and VR games, 2016.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
2016	45 to 46	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**Board of Directors, Wave** Joined the board of Wave, an immersive music experience company, in August 2016.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
August 2016	45	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Closing keynote, Games+Learning+Society (GLS16)** A sixty minute closing keynote at the Games+Learning+Society conference, August 2016. That spring I also spoke on the GDC panel Launching Students Well.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	GDC Vault, Launching Students Well
September 2016	45	SMPY	opportunity	**Update to SMPY, and an offer to help find participants who had lost touch** A change-of-address note, with an offer to help locate lapsed participants through my own networks. It was the first exchange with you that I can document.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My mailbox, September 2016 (available on request)
September 2016	45	SMPY	context	**Nature previews the mid-life survey of the 1 in 10,000 cohort** Tom Clynes, "How to raise a genius," Nature 537, 152 to 155 (8 September 2016), says you planned a mid-life survey of the profoundly gifted cohort. That is my cohort.	DOCUMENT	Nature, 8 September 2016 (ISIR-hosted PDF)
2017	46 to 47	Media and honors	outcome	**Playmakers Podcast, The 4 Pillars of Game Biz Success** Guest on the Playmakers Podcast, 2017.	DOCUMENT	Playmakers Podcast

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
February to September 2017	46	SMPY	context	**Mid-Life Survey invitations, February to September 2017** Invitations to the 2017 wave are in my mailbox. I am not describing my answers here; those are yours.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My mailbox (available on request)
2018	47 to 48	Media and honors	outcome	**Fireside chat, Gaming for Everyone (Xbox at GDC)** A public conversation on LGBTQIA+ people in gaming.	DOCUMENT	Microsoft Learn
2018	47 to 48	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Harvard reunion talk, Sanders Theater** Gave a seven minute talk at my Harvard reunion in Sanders Theater, "Games, a Journey of Discovery, Experience, Identity, and Sharing."	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, 9 July 2018
2018	47 to 48	Media and honors	outcome	**Nickelodeon Black History Month featurette** Featured in a Nickelodeon Black History Month video, around 2017 to 2018.	DOCUMENT	Nickelodeon
March 2018	47	Media and honors	outcome	**Lifetime Achievement Award, IGDA Black in Games SIG** My first lifetime-achievement honor, from the IGDA Black in Games Special Interest Group, which later evolved into the nonprofit Blacks in Gaming. Presented during GDC week in San Francisco, 22 March 2018. The plaque hangs on my wall.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own account (plaque) and my Facebook posts, March 2018
2019	48 to 49	Media and honors	outcome	**On screen in The World According to Jeff Goldblum** Appear as myself in one episode of the television series, 2019.	DOCUMENT	IMDb (my profile)

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
2019	48 to 49	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GGP Scholars program launched** Gay Gaming Professionals, which I co-founded in 2006, launched its Scholars program in 2019, the same year its partnership with Take-Two began. The organization is now in its 20th year and the Scholars program in its seventh.	DOCUMENT	Gay Gaming Professionals
October 2019	48	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Opening speaker, Penn State Behrend speaker series** Opened the university's speaker series on 1 October 2019.	DOCUMENT	Penn State Behrend
2020	49 to 50	Media and honors	outcome	**On camera in Netflix's High Score** Appears in episode 4 of High Score, the series on the history of video games.	DOCUMENT	Netflix
2020	49 to 50	Teaching and ethics	outcome	**Anatomy of a Game documentary series** USC and YouTube produced a documentary series chronicling my video game appreciation course, 2020.	DOCUMENT	YouTube
June 2020	49	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**First GGP Pride Stream on Twitch** Produced the first Gay Gaming Professionals Pride stream on Twitch, June 2020, honoring Dani Bunten.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, 1 June 2020
July 2020	49	Media and honors	outcome	**Games for Change Vanguard Award** Honored by Games for Change in July 2020.	DOCUMENT	GamesBeat
July 2020	49	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Keynote at Games for Change, "At the Table"** A keynote on the importance of community at the Games for Change virtual festival, 2020, the same festival season as the Vanguard Award.	DOCUMENT	Games for Change 2020 playlist

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
August 2020	49	Media and honors	outcome	**Sports Illustrated interview on realism in Madden** A video interview with Sports Illustrated on bringing realism to Madden NFL, 19 August 2020.	DOCUMENT	Sports Illustrated
2021	50 to 51	Work and industry	opportunity	**A year consulting for Stephanie McMahon at WWE** I spent a year consulting for Stephanie McMahon at WWE on its gaming business, beginning in 2021.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My own account
2021	50 to 51	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**E3 2021 diversity panel** Spoke on the E3 2021 panel on diversity in the games industry, on behalf of Take-Two.	DOCUMENT	CNET
March 2021	50	Media and honors	outcome	**USC Today profile, The Future of Video Games is Live** A university profile on live and interactive games.	DOCUMENT	USC Today
November 2021	51	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Distinguished Speaker Series, Bakersfield College** Featured speaker in the Bakersfield College Distinguished Speaker Series, 10 November 2021.	DOCUMENT	KGET
2022	51 to 52	SMPY	mentor	**You helped me prepare a talk, and sent the Nature piece and the documentary** I asked David for context for a talk to a STEM audience. He cleared an afternoon and sent the Nature feature and the SMPY documentary. I still point people to both.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My mailbox, 2022 (available on request)
March 2022	51	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GDC talk, Build Your Career in Games Like It's an RPG** Spoke at GDC on building a career in games like an RPG, 2022.	DOCUMENT	GDC speaker page

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
April 2022	51	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Lifetime honor at the Urban Arts Color Ball** Honored for my lifetime of work in games, education and belonging at Urban Arts' Color Ball, presented with Unity for Games, at the Ziegfeld Theatre in New York on 7 April 2022.	DOCUMENT	Urban Arts, 2022 end of year letter (p. 9)
June 2022	51	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GLS fireside chat and Games for Change festival** A fireside conversation at Games+Learning+Society (17 June 2022) and a speaker slot at the Games for Change festival, 2022.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, June 2022
September 2022	51	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Onstage at AFROTECH Executive LA** Onstage at AFROTECH Executive LA, 22 September 2022.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, September 2022
November 2022	52	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Main stage, National AFROTECH Conference** Spoke on the main stage in Austin on future-proofing diversity in gaming, 15 November 2022.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, November 2022
2023	52 to 53	Media and honors	outcome	**On screen in Rewind the '90s** Appear as myself in five episodes of the television mini series, 2023.	DOCUMENT	IMDb (my profile)
2023	52 to 53	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GGP CYSTEM mentorship program formalized** The CYSTEM mentorship program was formalized in 2023 with Take-Two as partner. It pairs students with working game professionals.	DOCUMENT	Gay Gaming Professionals
February 2023	52	Media and honors	outcome	**Daily Trojan profile, Redefining the Default** A student-newspaper profile of my work at USC.	DOCUMENT	Daily Trojan, 3 February 2023

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
March 2023	52	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GDC talk, Reimagining Game Industry Education** Spoke at GDC on reimagining game industry education, 24 March 2023.	DOCUMENT	GDC Vault
June 2023	52	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**Advisory board, Queer Vox** Joined the advisory board of Queer Vox, June 2023.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
July 2023	52	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**PNC Fairfax Connection STEM talk, Cleveland** Spoke to Cleveland students about STEM fields and their futures, 16 July 2023.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My slide notes for the talk
October 2023	52	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Presented the Ambassador Award, Tempest Awards** Presented the Ambassador Award to Angela Roseboro at the Tempest Awards, October 2023.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, October 2023
2024	53 to 54	SMPY	outcome	**Reading Composing Meaningful Lives** The 2023 Gifted Child Quarterly article on exceptional women and men at age 50 is the first comprehensive report from the mid-life follow-up I answered. SMPY sent it to me in its March 2024 update. I recognized my own cohort in it.	RECORD IN MY FILES	Lubinski, Benbow, McCabe and Bernstein, Gifted Child Quarterly 67(4), 2023
2024	53 to 54	Media and honors	outcome	**On screen in It's in the Game: Madden NFL** Appear as myself in two episodes of the television series, 2024.	DOCUMENT	IMDb (my profile)
March 2024	53	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GDC 2024 panels** Panels including Voices of Authenticity and an LGBTQ+ executive roundtable, March 2024.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
June 2024	53	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**IGN Live Pride panel** Spoke on a Pride panel at IGN Live, June 2024.	MY OWN ACCOUNT	My Facebook post, June 2024

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
October 2024	53	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Keynote as a Duke TIP alum, Carolinas Youth Mentoring Symposium** Keynote at the Carolinas Youth Mentoring Symposium in Durham, 12 October 2024, returning to the talent-search world that identified me.	DOCUMENT	Carolinas Youth Mentoring Symposium
2025	54 to 55	Teaching and ethics	turning point	**Director of Cinematic Ethics, USC School of Cinematic Arts** Named to the role in early 2025.	DOCUMENT	SCA In Motion, Winter 2025
2025	54 to 55	Work and industry	outcome	**Creative consultant, Wildgate** Creative consultant credit on the game Wildgate, 2025.	DOCUMENT	MobyGames (my credits)
2025	54 to 55	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**UConn fireside chat** A fireside chat at the University of Connecticut, 2025.	DOCUMENT	YouTube
2025	54 to 55	Media and honors	outcome	**Forged in Fire podcast** Guest on the Forged in Fire podcast, 2025.	DOCUMENT	Forged in Fire
March 2025	54	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Zero Proof Game Night at GDC** A community game night at GDC, second annual in March 2025 and third in March 2026.	DOCUMENT	Gay Gaming Professionals
March 2025	54	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GDC State of the Game Industry and Navigating Leadership panels** Took part in the inaugural GDC State of the Game Industry panel and the Navigating Leadership panel for LGBTQ+ leaders, March 2025.	DOCUMENT	GDC Vault
July 2025	54	Media and honors	outcome	**Podcast, Digital Civics (Valued Cultures)** A long conversation on games, ethics and civic life.	DOCUMENT	Valued Cultures
July 2025	54	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**Strategic advisor, ScoreSpace** Became a strategic advisor to ScoreSpace, July 2025.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
August 2025	54	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Collegiate Games Challenge, inaugural awards** The first Collegiate Games Challenge cycle awarded $90,000 in August 2025.	DOCUMENT	Gay Gaming Professionals
November 2025	54	Media and honors	outcome	**Keynote, Wisconsin Games Alliance MDEV** Opening-day keynote in Madison, Wisconsin, 7 and 8 November 2025.	DOCUMENT	Wisconsin Games Alliance
November 2025	55	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Voting member, BAFTA North America** Became a voting member of BAFTA North America, November 2025.	RECORD IN MY FILES	My public LinkedIn announcement
March 2026	55	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**Keynote at a Congressional Reception on Capitol Hill** Delivered the keynote at the Center for Excellence in Education Congressional Reception, Rayburn House Office Building foyer, Washington, 5 March 2026. The Center posted the reception program, including my remarks, to its channel. It was the second time in my life I addressed the federal government in Washington. The first was in 1984, at fourteen.	RECORD IN MY FILES	Center for Excellence in Education (email to me, 12 March 2026)
March 2026	55	Community and nonprofit	outcome	**GDC 2026 Commons Stage talk and Side Quest Podcast Live** Spoke on the Commons Stage at GDC and joined the Side Quest Podcast Live, March 2026.	DOCUMENT	GDC schedule
March 2026	55	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**Board member, qoral.** Joined the board of qoral., March 2026.	DOCUMENT	My LinkedIn profile
April 2026	55	Teaching and ethics	outcome	**Student AI buildathon, AI@USC and Good Vibes Only** A one-day student buildathon on using AI tools to make useful things, 19 April 2026.	DOCUMENT	LinkedIn posts, October 2025 and April 2026

WHEN	AGE	DOMAIN	TYPE	EVENT	EVIDENCE	SOURCE
June 2026	55	SMPY	decision	**Reconnecting with you both, and our conversation on 2 July 2026** I wrote to ask how I could be supportive of SMPY, and David offered a video call. You asked me to send media representing my past, present and future. This is that offering.	RECORD IN MY FILES	Our June and July 2026 correspondence
September 2026	55	Community and nonprofit	opportunity	**GamesBeat event advisory board** Named to GamesBeat's 28 person event advisory board, September 2026.	DOCUMENT	GamesBeat, Introducing our new GamesBeat event advisory board

Bellamy, G. (2026). *A record for Camilla Benbow and David Lubinski, offered by a member of SMPY Cohort 3.* Version 1.0, 2026-09-30. SHA-256 of record.json: `fd9a0424230a548c737bf325f856191c81ebdec0a7b725a1f8c84fc567d0aa2a`

The JSON download contains exactly the text used to compute that hash. The CSV is a table of the same event entries. Nothing is sent anywhere when you download.

The media room

Past, present and future, as you asked. Everything in the first two columns is public and opens in a new tab. Each card says in a line why it is here.

PAST

2016
Nature, How to raise a genius
You sent me this. It previews the survey my cohort answered.

2017
SMPY documentary, Quick Learners; High Achievers
Fourteen minutes from Peabody. I still point people to it.

2001 TO 2015
The Tape Log: nine game shows, 2001 to 2015
Recall and composure under pressure, on the record.

2002
Russian Roulette, full episode
The oldest full tape in the log.

2020
Netflix, High Score, episode 4
A history of games, with me in it.

VARIOUS
IMDb: my screen credits
Lists High Score, Rewind the '90s and The World According to Jeff Goldblum.

1993 TO 2025
MobyGames: my game credits
Lists my credits from Madden NFL '94 to Wildgate.

2018
Xbox at GDC: Gaming for Everyone
A public conversation about who gets to be in games.

2020
Games for Change Vanguard Award
A trade-press account of the honor.

2021
USC Today: The Future of Video Games is Live
My teaching, described by the university.

1992

The Harvard Crimson, 1992

Ten pieces from my student-reporter days, one on wrestling.

PRESENT

2026

USC School of Cinematic Arts profile

My title and role, as the university states them.

2023

Daily Trojan: Redefining the Default

A student reporter's long profile.

2025

Valued Cultures: Digital Civics

An unhurried conversation on games and civic life.

2025

Keynote at MDEV

The announcement for my keynote in Madison.

2026

Keynotes, boards and advisory (media log)

Where I speak and serve, with AI work labeled as work in progress.

2026

Gay Gaming Professionals

The nonprofit, its programs and its scholars.

FUTURE

Intentions, not achievements. Each is mine to keep or change.

INTENTION

Be useful to SMPY, if and when you want

As I wrote on 17 June, and say again now: I would gladly help with current participants or the next cohort, lend a voice, help reach underestimated gifted children, or connect the study to the AI moment. You set the terms.

INTENTION

AI empowerment, belonging, meaningful connections, big ideas

My own stated priorities for the year ahead. The connective idea is to make AI useful and keep people in the picture.

INTENTION

GGP Scholars, 2026 to 2027

A single scholars program across graduate and undergraduate levels, with an application closing 2 October 2026.

INTENTION

Teaching: AI, ethics and games at USC

Continuing to teach and to lead ethics for the School of Cinematic Arts, with AI as a working subject, not only a topic.

METHOD

How this was made, and what I left out

I prepared this with an AI research assistant that gathered and cross-checked sources, and I reviewed every entry. Where sources disagreed, I printed the most conservative wording or left the detail out. A person cannot independently verify their own life, so the entries marked `MY OWN ACCOUNT` should be read as exactly that. Corrections are welcome and I will thank you for them.

On purpose, this leaves out my test scores, my health, my finances, and details about other people. Those are mine to share if I ever choose to, and only with the consent of the people involved. The one exception is the optional panel about identity, closed by default.

THANK YOU

For the science, for the kindness, and for making time. If anything here is ever useful to you, I am glad. If it is not, please set it down; you owe me nothing. As I wrote in June, and say again now, if there is ever a way for me to help with current participants, the next cohort, or the study's questions about the years ahead, I would be honored to be asked.

Gordon Bellamy

Version 1.0 · 2026-09-30 · sha256 fd9a0424230a548c737bf325f856191c81ebdec0a7b725a1f8c84fc567d0aa2a

No analytics, no cookies, no external requests except links you open.